

Tania Ortiz

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at San Antonio — *B.B.A., Cybersecurity (Secure Software Analyst)*, GPA: 3.46 Dec 2026
Laredo College — *A.A.S., Cyber Defense, Honors* May 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

AWS, Azure, Linux, Docker, EJBCA, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, Python, PowerShell, Java, JavaScript, REST APIs, Git, SIEM, Prometheus, Grafana, KQL, Nessus, OpenSSL, ServiceNow, Splunk, SQL, CompTIA CySA+, CompTIA Security+, Anthropic
(Introduction to Claude Cowork, AI Fluency, Claude 101)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Texas Department of Transportation — *Cybersecurity Analyst Intern*, Remote, TX **Sept 2026 – Present**

- Supported enterprise cybersecurity operations by monitoring security events, conducting vulnerability assessments and incident investigations, and documenting findings using **SIEM, KQL**, and security monitoring tools.

PayPal — *Cybersecurity Engineer Intern*, Austin, TX **Jun 2026 – Sept 2026**

- Designed and executed **60+** compatibility and performance evaluations of NIST post-quantum certificates (ML-DSA-65/87, FIPS 204) vs. RSA-2048/4096 across **TLS 1.3, mTLS**, and **hybrid dual-cert server** configurations to evaluate enterprise PQC migration feasibility.
- Root-caused an ASN.1 encoding defect preventing **OpenSSL** from parsing ML-DSA private keys; corrected byte-level formatting and validated against live TLS 1.3 handshakes to unblock testing pipelines.
- Architected and executed automated benchmarking pipelines across **1,000+** trials, quantifying TLS and mTLS handshake latency trade-offs and identifying critical throughput advantages of ML-DSA over legacy high-bit RSA algorithms to inform production migration strategy.

CPS Energy — *IT Technician Intern*, San Antonio, TX **Jan 2026 – May 2026**

- Deployed and set up **300+** enterprise computers using USB boot configurations, including **30+** workstation and docking station setups with required software.
- Provided **Tier 1/2** technical support to **600+** employees, helping resolve network, **Active Directory (AD)**, and **MFA** issues through **ServiceNow**.

H-E-B, Inc. — *Network Engineering Intern*, San Antonio, TX **May 2025 – Aug 2025**

- Engineered a custom **Python** API metrics exporter to capture real-time telemetry from **4** network services and **7** hardware appliances.
- Managed containerized monitoring services across **3 Kubernetes clusters**, setting up health checks and **Grafana dashboards** to track network and system performance.
- Automated **CI/CD** pipelines with linting and testing, eliminating deployment overhead across **13+** production systems.

IBC Bank — *AML Analyst*, Laredo, TX **Mar 2024 – Aug 2024**

- Reviewed **40+** transaction monitoring alerts per day in **FCRM**, comparing customer activity against **KYC profiles** and maintaining an **85%** closure rate.
- Investigated approximately **10** high-risk cases per week, focusing on activity such as structuring, dormant account reactivations, and high-value cross-border wires.
- Documented investigation findings and prepared detailed case narratives for **SAR** review, following **BSA/AML** and **FinCEN** requirements and escalating suspicious activity when appropriate.

PROJECTS

AI-Powered Phishing Detector | *Python, Plotly Dash, AWS (IAM, VPC, S3, RDS), Cursor AI, Google Colab, Terraform*

- Architected a security platform combining **TF-IDF heuristics** and a fine-tuned **DistilBERT transformer** across **111,754 URLs** and **17,537 emails**, achieving **99.98% URL accuracy** and **97.21% email accuracy** with **0% false positives** on transformer evaluations.
- Deployed a **FastAPI** backend and **Plotly Dash** frontend on **AWS** via **Terraform**.

System Information Exporter | *Grafana, Prometheus, Python*

- Architected a monitoring system using **FastAPI** to collect host CPU, memory, process, and GPU metrics.
- Integrated **Prometheus** for scraping, an **Isolation Forest** model for real-time anomaly detection, and **Grafana** dashboards for live system observability.

Centralized Logging & Monitoring System | *Apache Kafka, ELK Stack, Docker*

- Implemented a real-time **log ingestion pipeline** with structured parsing and interactive dashboards.

Automated Cloud Compliance Auditor | *AWS Config, Security Hub, S3, SNS, IAM, Lambda, CloudTrail*

- Developed a **DevSecOps platform** auditing cloud infrastructure against **CIS, HIPAA, and PCI-DSS** with automated alerts and remediation.

SOC HomeLab | *Microsoft Sentinel, Azure Monitor Agent, KQL*

- Integrated VM logs into **Microsoft Sentinel** via Azure Monitor Agent (**AMA**) for centralized real-time security monitoring.
- Created and tested Kusto Query Language (**KQL**) rules to detect unauthorized RDP sign-in attempts and trigger security alerts.

CloudHUB | *Nextcloud, AWS EC2, Docker, Tailscale VPN*

- Self-hosted productivity workspace on **AWS EC2**, secured with **Tailscale VPN** and deployed via **Docker**.